Kermit (No, Not The Frog...)

Columbia University, in 1981, developed the Kermit protocol to transfer files between microcomputers, their servers, and floppy disks on their university network—just like the FTP protocol. It was important at the time because it was compatible with different types of computer hardware and software available. The protocol was ported to work on Windows, Linux, UNIX, Apple, and OS2 platforms. The Kermit Project is still alive, and co-ordinated by the University. It is used by the International Space Station to run a myriad hardware components encompassing many generations.

tridges and tapes. As its popularity increased, more and more software titles like home finance programs, spreadsheets, and communication terminal programs became available on cartridges.

Linus Torvalds, who later went on to write the Linux kernel, used the VIC-20 as his first computer.

June: Hayes' modem

Developed by Dennis C Hayes, co-founder of Hayes Microcomputer Products, the Hayes Smartmodem was the first commercially-successful modem. Its predecessor, the CAT, by Novation, was an acoustically-coupled modem. The Smartmodem however, used an external micro coupler to transfer data digitally from the phone lines to the computer, making the connection more stable.

The Smartmodem did have its problems, however. For one, computer manufacturers then had very different circuit board designs from each other, so it was difficult to fit the modem onto them all. It would also require individual driver software to run on different circuit board designs, often resulting in compatibility issues when incorrect driver software was used. Hayes decided to use the RS232C serial port, which was normally available on all circuit boards, to run his modem.